

Amy Handlan

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Citizenship: USA

Education

- PhD in Economics, University of Minnesota, 2021
- MA in Economics, University of Minnesota, 2018
- BS in Economics (Math Minor), George Mason University, 2015

Positions

- Yang Family Assistant Professor in Economics, Brown University, 2021–Present
- Research Analyst / Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, 2018–2020
- Graduate Instructor / Teaching Assistant, University of Minnesota, 2016–2019

Visiting Positions

- Visiting Scholar (Sabbatical), Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis and University of Minnesota, Spring 2025
- Visiting Scholar (Sabbatical), University of California – Berkeley, Fall 2024
- Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, 2022–2024
- Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, 2024
- AEA-CSWEP Summer Economics Fellow, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Summer 2021

Published Papers

- “Gender Differences in Economics Seminars,” with Pascaline Dupas, Alicia Sasser Modestino, Muriel Niederle, Mateo Seré, Haoyu Sheng, Justin Wolfers, and the Seminar Dynamics Collective (2026). *American Economic Review* 116 (2): 749–89.

Working Papers

- “Reputation for Confidence,” with Laura Gáti
- “Monetary Communication Rules,” with Laura Gáti
- “FedSpeak Matters: FOMC Statements and Monetary Policy Expectations”
- “Text Shocks and Monetary Surprises: Text Analysis of FOMC Statements with Machine Learning”

Work in Progress

- “Government-Directed R&D and Innovation: Evidence from NASA Budget Requests,” with Ethan Ilzetzki and Réka Juhász
- “FedSpeak Indicators,” with Sara Canilang and Amanda Michaud
- “Hot off the Press: Newspaper Sentiment and Economic Fluctuations,” with Jennifer La’O
- “Joint Taxation and Labor Supply,” with Ross Batzer

Old Working Papers

- “Gender and Tone in Recorded Economics Presentations: Audio Analysis with Machine Learning,” with Haoyu Sheng

Dissertation

- “Text Shocks and Monetary Surprises”
- Committee: Christopher Phelan, VV Chari, Loukas Karabarbounis, and Hengjie Ai

Presentations

- **2026:** Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, McGill University, Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City, Texas Monetary Conference (Rice University), Federal Reserve Bank of Boston (discussant), Canadian Economic Association Conference (Vancouver, BC), SED Conference (Athens, Greece), HHEI UMN Alumni Conference Keynote, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago*
- **2025:** ASSA (San Francisco, CA), University of Warwick, Bank of England, Boston University Text Conference, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, AMLEDS Seminar, Indiana University, Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, European Central Bank, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, University of Houston, University of Connecticut
- **2024:** ASSA (San Antonio, TX), Princeton University, NBER Monetary Economics Spring Workshop (Chicago, IL) (discussant), Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, Conference of the International Research Forum on Monetary Policy (Washington, DC), Conference on Central Bank Communications: Theory and Practice (FRB-Cleveland, OH) (discussant), Yale School of Management, Central Bank of Ireland, London School of Economics, SED Conference (Barcelona, Spain), University of California – Berkeley, Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco, Google, Monetary Policy Conference: Bridging Science and Practice (European Central Bank, Frankfurt), Stanford University, Southern Economic Association Meeting (Washington, DC)
- **2023:** ASSA (New Orleans, LA), Tufts University, Boston University, Western Finance Association (San Francisco, CA) (discussant), Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland, Banque de France, European Central Bank, NBER Monetary Economics Fall Workshop, Southern Economic Association Meeting (New Orleans, LA), Federal Reserve Bank of Boston, Columbia University, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia

- **2022:** West Virginia University, University of California – Berkeley, University of California – San Diego, Western Economic Association Meeting (Portland, OR), CEPR Central Bank Communication Seminar, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Conference on Frontiers in Machine Learning and Economics (Philadelphia, PA), Southern Economic Association Meeting (Ft. Lauderdale, FL)
- **2021:** Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, Office of the Comptroller of the Currency, Carleton College, Harvard Business School, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, Western University, Hamilton College, University of Georgia, Congressional Budget Office, Federal Reserve Bank of New York, Analysis Group – Denver, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Brown University, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, Northwestern University, Online Seminar in Economics + Data Science, University of Texas – Austin
- **2020:** University of Minnesota, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Vanderbilt University, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Ryerson University
- **Pre-2020:** Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings (Athens, GA), Midwest Economic Association Meeting (Evanston, IL), Eastern Economic Association Meeting (New York, NY)

Courses

Brown University

- Econ 2460 (PhD): Applied Macro and Text Analysis (Fall 2025, 2026)
- Econ 1210: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Fall 2022, Spring 2024, 2026, 2027)
- Econ 1680: Machine Learning, Text Analysis, and Economics (Spring 2022, 2023, 2024)

University of Minnesota

- Econ 3101: Intermediate Microeconomics (Fall 2016 – Spring 2019)

Other

- SIDE Summer School of Econometrics (NLP Economics), July 2025

Service

Department Service

- Junior Recruiting Committee (AY21-22, AY22-23, AY24-25)
- Brown Macro Seminar Organizer (Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Fall 2023, Fall 2025, Fall 2026)
- Undergraduate Advising (APMA/Math/CS-Econ Concentration) (AY23-24, AY26-27)
- Brown Junior Faculty Lunch Workshop Organizer (AY23-24)
- Brown Macro Reading Group (2021–2023)

Referee

American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, Economic Journal, International Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Finance, Journal of International Economics, Journal of Macroeconomics, Journal of Monetary Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Nature, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Review of Economic Dynamics, Review of Economic Studies, Sociological Methods & Research

External

- Minnesota Economics Big Data Institute Machine Learning Competition, 2022
- HHEI University of Minnesota Alumni Conference (2022-2026)
- SED Conference Session Organizer (2024, 2026)

Honors and Awards

- 2019–2020: Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, University of Minnesota
- 2018–2019: Distinguished Instructor, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota
- 2018: Career Readiness Graduate Instructor Teaching Fellowship, University of Minnesota
- 2016–2017: Herbert Mohring Fellowship, University of Minnesota
- 2016–2017: Distinguished Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota
- 2015–2016: Bert and Susan Hill Gross Fellowship, University of Minnesota
- 2015: NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program Honorable Mention
- 2015: Howard R. Bloch Memorial Award (highest GPA in economics), George Mason University
- 2015: OSCAR Student Excellence Award, George Mason University
- 2015: Economics Departmental Honors; Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society; Omicron Delta Epsilon Economics Honor Society, George Mason University
- 2014: Undergraduate Research Scholars Program Grant, George Mason University

Teaching

Courses

- Econ 2460: Applied Macroeconomics and Text Analysis (PhD Level)
 - Brown University: Fall 2026, 2025
 - Past enrollment: 13
- Econ 1210: Intermediate Macroeconomics
 - Brown University: Spring 2027, 2026, 2024, Fall 2022

- Average enrollment per section: 75
- Econ 1680: Machine Learning, Text Analysis, and Economics
 - Brown University: Spring 2022, 2023, 2024
 - Average enrollment per section: 35
- Econ 3101: Intermediate Microeconomics
 - University of Minnesota: 2017 - 2019
 - Average enrollment per section: 200

Advising

- Brown Ph.D. theses advised: 2 (co-main advisor) and 3 (committee member)
- External Ph.D. committee member: 3 (Northwestern, UT-Austin, and McGill University)
- Brown Undergraduate Honors theses advised: 4
- Current graduate students advising: 7